

County Commissioners Meeting - September 8th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=otdV5IMrvuo
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Delaware County Municipal Meeting Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** [00:00:37](#) Finance Board Special Meeting focusing on investment policy amendments to allow the Delaware County Drainage Board and Delaware County Community Corrections to invest in Trust Indiana and retain their investment income locally rather than reverting to the general fund.
- **Summary of Discussion:** Treasurer Pulk presented the investment opportunity via Trust Indiana, noting an estimated investment of \$900,000 for the drainage board, generating an estimated \$2,500 monthly in interest. The board discussed expanding this to other non-general funds, raising concerns from the County Council about opening the "floodgates" to department investment requests that could impact the general fund budget. Legal counsel clarified statutory authority for investments. The meeting concluded with a motion to recess the finance meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Commissioner Rian called the regular Delaware County Commissioners meeting to order on Tuesday, September 8, 2026, at 9:06 AM.

- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commissioner Brand, Commissioner Henry, Commissioner Rian, and Treasurer Pulk.
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Commissioner Rian.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening Pledge of Allegiance led by attendees.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - August 3, 2026 meeting minutes removed from the table and Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Emergency meeting minutes of August 13, 2026, Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Commissioners' meeting minutes of August 17, 2026, Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:19:24 Board of Health Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** It was noted that previously appointed Dr. Jeffrey Olrich retired and moved out of the county. The board moved to appoint the second recommendation from the health department board, Dr. Hal Dixon.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Rian - yes).
- **00:21:01 American Tower Lease Extension**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Brook / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a lease extension request from American Tower through 2061 (a 30-year extension), featuring a 12.5% rate increase every five years. The company refused revenue sharing on a second tenant, but offered 30% revenue sharing on a third tenant. Alternative proposals (such as Landmark Development) were deemed unviable.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Henry - yes, Brand - no, Rian - yes).
- **00:27:43 Soil and Water Conservation Funding**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Jenna
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion to remove the Soil and Water Conservation update from the table and continue funding them at \$25,000, sourcing the remaining \$4,000 from the commissioners' budget.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:30:10 Health Department Safe Sleep Grant Application**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tamara White & Erica Brandon (Delaware County Health Department)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requesting approval to apply for a second round of the Indiana Department of Health's Injury Prevention Grant for \$10,000, entirely dedicated to safe sleep programs (providing pack-and-plays and sleep sacks).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Rian - yes).
- **00:35:01 Sheriff's Office Operation Pullover Grant (CHRP) Acceptance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Captain Tony Johnson (Delaware County Sheriff's Office)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Notification and request to accept a 2027 Operation Pullover / Comprehensive Highway Injury Reduction Program (CHRP) grant in the amount of \$130,532, utilizing an existing reimbursement fund.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Henry - yes, Brand - yes, Rian - yes).
- **00:36:26 Highway Department Safety Procedure Amendment (Tree Removal)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Dean
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formalizing safety procedures requiring utility power lines to be grounded and tagged before highway personnel cut or remove trees near lines, prioritizing worker safety.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Rian - yes).
- **00:39:00 Right Stuff Software / Payroll Timekeeping Cloud Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carol / Ed
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding contract terms and data backup guarantees with payroll provider Right Stuff. Concerns were raised over the vendor's refusal to put 100% data backup guarantees in writing, liability, and multi-year auto-renewals without annual board review.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Failed by Voice Vote (Roll call: Brand - no, Henry - yes, Rian - no).
- **00:50:28 Utility Study Easement Documents (High Voltage Line Project)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A request allowing utility companies to include a small county-owned wooded parcel along County Road 1275 North in a transmission power project study connecting Indiana to Ohio. Documents include a statement of authority and memorandum of option.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved upon legal counsel review by Voice Vote (Roll call: Bham - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes).
- **00:36:28 Justice Center Roof Bids Opening**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Public opening and reading of roof bids for the Justice Center from four contractors:

- *McGuff Roofing (Muncie, IN):* Area 1: \$364,000; Area 2: \$213,000; Area 3: \$200,000; Area 4: \$144,200; Area 5: \$157,000; Area 6: \$313,500.
 - *KP Enterprises (Hammond, IN):* Area 1: \$209,800; Area 2: \$16,000; Area 3: \$64,000; Area 4: \$78,000; Area 5: \$74,500; Area 6: \$76,600.
 - *Simmons Roof Maintenance (Gaston, IN):* Area 1: \$348,641; Area 2: \$177,280; Area 3: \$107,246; Area 4: \$132,747; Area 5: \$122,817; Area 6: \$142,692.
 - *Hinshaw Roofing and Sheet Metal (Frankfort, IN):* Area 1: \$295,800; Area 2: \$142,680; Area 3: \$80,000; Area 4: \$104,000; Area 5: \$117,000; Area 6: \$118,395.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Taken under advisement by Voice Vote.
- **00:59:41 Bridge 65 Timber Frame Repair**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Thomas
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discovered cracked spreader beam on Bridge 65 (700 West south of 500 North). Quotes include \$85,000 for labor, \$25,360 for materials, and approx. \$5,000 for waterproofing/asphalt (totaling ~\$115,000). Replacement with a concrete bridge would cost \$1.9M–\$2.2M. Repair extends bridge life by at least 15 years. Funded via Cumulative Bridge Fund with potential FEMA reimbursement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Bram - yes, Henry - yes, Rian - yes).
- **01:03:48 Justice Center Man-Door Installation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don Chambers (Superintendent, Delaware County Buildings)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Quote of \$3,500 from ABC Contracting for labor to install a pedestrian man-door next to the large garage door at the Justice Center to improve safety and thermal efficiency during winter. Paid out of EDIT 12.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Henry - yes, Bram - yes, Regg - yes).
- **01:06:00 Justice Center Security Camera & Cable Repairs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don Chambers
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Quote from Titan Electric totaling \$6,381.10 to run new cables for security doors, speakers, and dock cameras (Door 9 and Door 5) to close out accurate controls service plans. Paid out of EDIT 12.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Bram - yes, Henry - yes, Rian - yes).
- **01:07:35 Exterior Pressure Washing Quote**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don Chambers / Commissioner Rian
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Quote of \$2,250 from Happy Cans to pressure wash sidewalks, stone walkways, and retaining walls outside the building (excluding exterior building walls requiring specialized sealing). Paid out of EDIT 12.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Brand - yes, Regan - yes).

- **01:09:58 Burton Advisors Broadband Consulting Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Contract to put Delaware County on a 12-week timeline to achieve broadband-ready designation and secure state BEAD program funds (\$868M total state allocation; 880 unserved rural addresses in Delaware County). Funded via IT funds (Project 11).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Rian - yes).
- **01:12:01 Humana Medicare Advantage Prescription Program Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lee Royal (Human Resources)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual renewal of the elective Humana Medicare Advantage prescription program for retirees at zero cost to the county.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:13:10 Personnel Handbook Amendment: Educational/Military Incentive Pay & Fitness for Duty**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lee Royal & Daniel
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Updating handbook language to officially align with ongoing practices: extending educational and military incentive pay to all full-time eligible employees (not just continuous operations) and clarifying that departmental budgets must cover fitness-for-duty examinations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes).
- **01:15:39 Title VI Implementation Plan Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lee Royal
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Updating the Title VI implementation plan coordinator to Lee Royal, updating organizational point-of-contacts, and refreshing 2027 goals.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Henry - yes, Rian - yes).
- **01:16:33 Benton Road Storm Water Detention Pond Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferring ownership of a subdivision detention pond on Benton Road from the county commissioners to the Muncie Sanitary District to facilitate upcoming stormwater improvement projects.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Rian - yes).
- **01:17:49 Purdue Extension Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewing contract and budget amendments regarding Purdue Extension staffing shifts (moving from two county-funded administrative positions to one resource) and a 45% regional service model cost increase. Council noted budget discrepancies regarding spent vs. approved lines.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled by Voice Vote.
- **01:24:31 4590 East / 450 South Property Asbestos Abatement Lien Release**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Tom Fouch
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request by a new property owner to remove a county asbestos abatement lien (\$16,150) on a long-troubled property in exchange for building a new house and returning the parcel to active tax rolls.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes).
- **01:25:54 Ordinances for First Reading:**
 - **01:26:31 Ordinance 2026-016:** Ordinance amending the county personal handbook regarding educational incentive pay eligibility for all employees (excluding court system and health department; Sheriff's Office discussed requesting inclusion). *Introduced by Voice Vote.*
 - **01:26:58 Ordinance 2026-017:** Ordinance amending the county personal handbook for fitness-for-duty examinations (departmental budgeting and payment responsibility). *Introduced by Voice Vote.*
 - **01:27:37 Ordinance 2026-018:** Ordinance adjusting pay periods for 2027 and beyond (accommodating 26 or 27 pay cycles automatically without recurring ordinance amendments). *Introduced by Voice Vote.*
 - **01:29:29 Ordinance 2026-019:** Ordinance establishing the Lane Mile Direct Distribution Fund (Fund 1242) for the highway department (\$459,009.99 allocation). *Introduced by Voice Vote.*
- **01:30:57 Ordinances for Second Reading:**
 - **Ordinance 2026-015:** Ordinance amending Chapter 3-5 related to grass and weeds for Delaware County. *Tabled for clean copy preparation.*

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:11:37 Ricky Newsman:** Addressed the board commending the county's disaster recovery response and emphasizing the absolute criticality of maintaining emergency communication infrastructure. Expressed concerns regarding ongoing spending on the Justice Center and rising tax burdens.
- *(Note: No other public comment speakers recorded during the general forum.)*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Commissioner Brand:** Noted upcoming MUNI meetings, cybersecurity training deadlines (Sept 22), open enrollment schedules, supervisor training, and Indiana Michigan Power (I&M) rate decrease filings driven by large load/data center growth.

- **Building Maintenance (Don Chambers):** Noted completion of county building LED lighting upgrades via utility incentive programs; announced crane operations closing front handicap parking at the Justice Center the following day for HVAC chiller work.
- **Weights and Measures (Eric Stroud):** Introduced new employee Allison Truax.
- **Emergency Management (Corey Kiss & Caleb Palsma):** Provided updates on flood disaster individual/public assistance recovery centers, processing ~150–200 residents, temporary housing placements for 19 displaced families, waterway/logjam mitigation meetings with IDHS, and introduced new Deputy Director Caleb Palsma.
- **Communications (Fred):** Detailed ongoing communications tower recovery efforts, flood-plane elevation designs (6-foot exoskeleton), temporary police radio stopgaps, and funding considerations via bond bank emergency loans.
- **Plan Commission (Kysten Swackr):** Provided updates on the comprehensive ordinance revision process, stakeholder meeting scheduling (Sept 22–24), and public input forms.
- **Health Department:** Announced free mosquito repellent distribution at 125 North Mulberry Street while supplies last.
- **Veterans Affairs:** Announced the Delaware County Stand Down on September 15th from 10:00 AM to 2:00 PM at the Heartland Hall Building (Fairgrounds).
- **Sheriff Tony Skinner:** Requested that the Sheriff's Office be explicitly included in the personnel handbook coverage scope under Ordinance 2026-016.
- **Claims & Payroll Approvals:**
 - General claims approved in the amount of \$6,504,378.33.
 - ARP claims approved in the adjusted amount of \$3,672.50 (subtracting items pre-approved in special meetings).
 - Payroll approved in the adjusted amount of \$992,612.83.
- **Adjournment:** Official meeting recessed / adjourned by Voice Vote at the conclusion of business.